

Candidate Name : _____



CENTRAL EAST EDUCATION DIVISION

2025 MOCK EXAMINATIONS



ENGLISH

Subject Number: M052/III

Thursday, 27 March

Time Allowed: 2 hours

(02:00-4:00pm)

PAPER III

(70 marks)

Instructions

1. This paper contains 9 printed pages.

Please check.

2. The paper has two sections: **A** and **B**.

3. You should spend the first **10 minutes** reading all the questions and planning your answers to the questions you choose.

4. Write your **name** at the top of each page of the question paper.

5. In the table provided on this page, **tick** against the question number you have answered.

6. At the end of the examination, hand in your paper to the invigilator.

Question Number	Tick questions answered	Do not write in these margins	
1			
2			
4			

Candidate Name : _____

SECTION A (30 marks)

Answer **both** questions in this section in the spaces provided

1. POETRY

GEOGRAPHY TEACHER

Our teacher told us one day he would leave
And sail across a warm blue sea
To places he had only known from maps.
And all his life had lodged to be

The house he lived in was narrow and grey
But in his mind's eye he could see
Sweet-scented jasmine cling to the walls
And green leaves burning on an orange tree.

He spoke of the lands he longed to visit
Where it was never drab or cold
I couldn't understand why he never left
And shook off the schools' stranglehold

Then halfway through his final term
He took ill and never returned
he never got to that place on the map
Where the green leaves of the orange trees burned

The maps were redrawn on the classroom wall;
His name forgotten, he faded away.
But a lesson he never knew he taught
Is with me to this day.

Candidate Name : _____

I travel to where the green leaves burn,
To where the ocean's glass-clear and blue,
To places our teacher taught me to love-
And which he never knew

Questions

- a. (i) what is the mood of the poem?

(1 mark)

- (ii) Justify your answer in a (i)

(1 mark)

- b. Explain the meaning of the following expression “**the mind's eye**”

(2 marks)

- c. “....But a lesson he never knew he taught” what is the lesson that he taught?

(2 marks)

- d. Pick out one example of each of the following figures of speech in the poem.

- (i) Alliteration

(1 mark)

- (ii) Metaphor

(1 mark)

Candidate Name : _____

(iii) Personification

(1 marks)

e. Describe any **two** themes portrayed in the poem.

(i) _____

(2marks)

(ii) _____

(2 marks)

f. Describe any one character of the persona.

(2 marks)

2. SHORT STORY

Read the passage carefully and answer the questions that follow

THE FAILED ESCAPE

“Everyone get out of the bus! Now!” a muscular police officer shouted at all of us on board.

I was puzzled. How did these police officers find out about my escape journey? Everything was planned smoothly. No one was supposed to smell a rat. Who tipped the police? Could Ndaona have had a hand in it?

I was still in school when I got pregnant. I was barely fifteen years old when I gave birth to my daughter Ziona. When I missed four monthly cycles, I dropped out of school and my uncle’s temper flew out of the roof. He was hot with fury like hell itself. We could smell his anger from a distance. He had two options;

Candidate Name : _____

hack James with a machete or send him to jail. Yes, the man who defiled me was James.

However, James was very cunning. He quickly convinced my mother that he would take care of me and the baby. He promised to send me back to school after giving birth and eventually wed me. He left a fat wad of cash that left my mother smiling and hopeful. Even uncle found it hard to hide the excitement that was written all over his face. He knew he had become an overnight beer merchant.

Indeed, James started supporting me during pregnancy. He was a businessman who specialised in agribusiness. JAMES AGRO-TRADE was the leading shop and the number one shop for farmers. Every week he gave my mother some soap, meat, rice, cooking oil and some money. He also never forgot a little something for my uncle. Slowly he became a darling for my uncle and mother. They liked him so much. Sometimes more than me.

Things took an ugly turn when we woke up to a rude awakening one Saturday morning. JAMES AGRO-TRADE was empty and closed. James had evaporated like vapour on a hot summer. No one knew where his legs had carried him. In his mind he had played a grandmaster's chess move; a maestro's stroke. He thought all of us could easily give up on him just like that. Had he known?

A long time had gone by. James was merely a memory in the village. Everyone forgot about him but me. How could I forget him when I saw his face every day? Yes, my daughter Ziona had her father's face. Every time I saw Ziona a bitter memory of James flashed the back of my memory with unresolved trauma. I felt betrayed and foolish. A lake of tears gashed down my cheeks.

One afternoon, a rumour flew past my hungry ears that James was in Lilongwe. I wasn't very certain about his specific location but Area 47 was mentioned. Rumour had it that he was happily married to a beautiful woman. Blood rushed to my brain and sent me into a migraine headache. So I envisaged a plan, some

Candidate Name : _____

may call it evil but who cares? Violence must always be responded with violence. That had been my philosophy from the day I was betrayed.

I left Zione with my mother at night and fled the village. No, I did not inform my mother. She discovered departure the next day. No one knew where I went. I took a minibus to Lilongwe. I did not know where Area 47 was at that time. So I went to Chinsapo where my friend Ndaona was staying. She was living in a small house with one bedroom. She was staying alone since she had also abandoned her kid in Mingu Village, Mchinji District. She was not employed but she managed to stay alone. She had a business going on after hours. Since I needed money to survive, I also joined the night business. No, I will not reveal the business. That will be a secret forever. I worked diligently until time came when I got tired of the business and decided to say bye to Ndaona.

“I have decided to become a house maid. I will move to Area 47 to look for a day job,” I told Ndaona.

I did not wait for her response. I did not need her permission. I left Chinsapo and went straight to Area 47. I worked very hard to find out where James was working. It took me three days to discover where he was staying. I quickly landed on a job as a house maid. No, not at James’s house. It was at his neighbour’s house where I started working.

In a few days, I became friends with James’ wife. I used to frequent their house whenever James went to work. He had never seen me. He did not even know his spouse had a new companion. His wife was a beautiful woman with a kind and humble heart. Sometimes I could offer to wash her kid’s clothes since she did not have a maid. She did not believe in having a maid because she was a house wife. Sometimes I could cook for her too. Little did she know that she was keeping a snake hidden in the grass.

Candidate Name : _____

My day for revenge came. My evil plan was simple. I bought some insecticide and poured it in the family's dinner. In the morning, the whole family perished; James, his wife and their four-year-old kid. I was gone the same morning. I started my escape journey to Zambia the next day. I was on a bus to Zambia when the police stopped us and arrested me on charges of murder. I am in prison serving a life sentence now.

a. From what point of view is the story told?

(1 mark)

b. How does James convince the family after he ran in trouble?

(2 marks)

c. How has the narrator achieved flashback in the story?

(2 marks)

d. What figures of speech do the following expressions present?

(i) we could smell his anger

(1 mark)

(ii) a lake of tears gashed down my cheeks

(1 mark)

e. Why does the narrator call herself a snake in the grass?

Candidate Name : _____

(2 marks)

f. Describe the character of James.

(2 marks)

g. Explain any two themes from the story.

(i) _____

(2 marks)

(ii) _____

(2 marks)

Section B (40 marks)

Answer **both** questions in this section in the spaces provided. Choose either **a** or **b** in each case and **not both**.

3. **THE PEARL** by John Steinbeck

EITHER

a. Using **four** points in each case, discuss how the following themes have been portrayed in the book “The Pearl”.

- (i) Disillusionment
- (ii) Hope

OR

Candidate Name : _____

- b. Using **eight** points from the novel “The Pearl” discuss how the discovery of the pearl has changed the behavior of Kino.

4. **MACBETH** by William Shakespeare

EITHER

- a. Using **eight** points from the play, “Macbeth” discuss how the theme of moral decadence is portrayed.

OR

- b. With **four** points in each case, discuss the character of the following in the Play “Macbeth”

- (i) Malcom
- (ii) Captain

[illegible]

Candidate Name : _____

[illegible]

Candidate Name : _____

[illegible]

[illegible]

END OF QUESTION PAPER